LITTLE WONDERS ESL

History Word Lab: The printing press

Level B1 · about 25 minutes · books for everyone



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a machine with metal letters. I print many copies of the same page.
2. I was a German goldsmith. Around 1440, I invented a new way to print books in Europe.
3. Printers cover metal letters with me before they put paper on top.

2 COOL FACT: BOOKS BECOME CHEAPER

Before the 1400s, people copied books **by hand**, so books were rare and expensive. Around 1440, Johannes **Gutenberg**, a German goldsmith, invented a printing **press** with movable metal **letters**. Workers arranged the letters to make words, covered them with **ink** and pressed paper on top. A press could print many copies of the same page. The first big book that Gutenberg printed was the Bible. Printing made books cheaper, so more people learned to read, and news and new ideas spread across **Europe**.

rare = not easy to find

expensive = costing a lot of money

invented = made for the first time

goldsmith = a person who makes things from gold

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

X	O	N	A	I	F	G	R	P	G	P	E
E	A	N	H	J	E	T	H	R	I	E	E
C	D	R	D	I	R	E	A	E	N	U	D
B	A	L	E	T	T	E	R	S	K	R	H
O	I	S	P	A	P	E	R	S	D	O	Q
O	A	R	A	O	H	A	N	D	O	P	N
K	G	U	T	E	N	B	E	R	G	E	R
B	C	A	M	I	R	R	U	G	E	C	R

WORD BANK

- ☐ **press**
- ☐ **Gutenberg**
- ☐ **ink**
- ☐ **paper**
- ☐ **letter**
- ☐ **book**
- ☐ **Europe**
- ☐ **hand**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. How did people make books before the printing press?
2. Who invented the printing press in Europe?
3. How did printing change the world?